If you want to get good at UIX design, you got to start with the basics. So, let's begin.

This one's easiest to explain with an example first. If I have three text and icon pairs, but I put a container around drinks and food, you know that they're related and dessert is not. Then, if I put a container around drinks, you know that it's selected and you can toggle over to food. And if I gray this text out, you know that it's inactive and clicking it probably won't do anything. See how you just knew all of that? I didn't need to write instructions on how it worked because the UI was signifying how things worked. Good UI has many signifiers like a button press state, highlights on active nav items, hover states, or even tool tips to tell the user what a UI affords or what it can do.

Now, take a look at this card. It displays all of the information in a logical, repeatable format, but it looks like a spreadsheet, not a design. So, let's give it some hierarchy, which is pretty intuitive. We have size, position, and color to use to our advantage. Starting from the top, an image always adds a great pop of color and makes scanning super easy. Just like Uber, if in this case the item is the most important, we want that large and bold and at the top because otherwise it'll blend in with something like the time and day, which can be below and much smaller. And it's this contrast, the difference between small and big, or colorful and not that actually creates the hierarchy. It's also why price should be at the top, right aligned, and blue. It's different than the rest, which draws the eye to it. The location should be smaller and below like this. But instead of just from and to, we can use icons and a line to demonstrate that

it's moving from Jamesville to Syracuse without having to actually say that. Now, with that said, it's not an exact science, and you could definitely end up with a design that looks like this instead. And it wouldn't be wrong, but the same ideas apply. Most important things near the top, bigger and colorful is more important, and images are used whenever possible. And as you start to design more and more, you'll notice that similar patterns arise when you need labels or buttons, which we're going to talk about in a minute.

Now, some people have this misconception that all of your content needs to align to a 12 column grid and be exactly 8 pixels apart, but these are just guidelines. For example, this design doesn't line up with any of the columns, and that's not uncommon, especially for custom landing pages. But for highly structured pages like galleries, blogs or any repeating content, they can actually be useful for responsiveness by giving guidelines for responsive behavior on tablet with eight columns and mobile with four. But much more important than using excessive grids and layouts is whites space. Letting things breathe. For example, in a simple section like this, the large text would have a font size and line height like this, and the subtext would have a font size and line height like so. buttons would be similar and optionally a top announcement bar like this. Then simply 32 pixels between every item, but you can also group elements that just go together like the announcement and text or the text and subtext which is just another form of visual hierarchy. And this is where we see the fourpoint grid system actually come into play. Everything is a multiple, not because it inherently looks better, but because you can always split things in half, which

creates consistency throughout a design. Typography is really interesting because design is mostly just text. And for picking a font, I can almost unilaterally say you'll never need more than one for any design. So find a nice sans sarah font like the ones on screen and stick to it. Over the last 7 years of designing, I've rarely used any fonts other than what's on screen, and this shouldn't be where you're spending tons of time. I'm also not a big fan of calling any design skill a hack, but this one kind of is. This design looks okay right now, but our header text feels a little too loose. If you tighten up the letter spacing on this by about -2 tog -3% and drop the line height to about 110 to 120%, it instantly makes any larger text look super pro real fast. But hierarchy with typography is a little bit more nuanced. And if we look at our previous example, text sizes can vary wildly. For landing pages and websites, you generally don't want more than six font sizes, which can have a really large range. For things like dashboards, that range shrinks dramatically to where you don't normally have text sizes larger than 24 pixels because of the increase in information density. But honestly, one of the most important concepts of design is getting inspiration and doing research from a good source like today's sponsor, Mobin, who curates hundreds of thousands of mobile and web apps along with landing pages, too. So, you can always pull inspiration from real designs built by the top design teams in the world. And if you're struggling with a specific section, just go and search for it and instantly pull up real world examples with links to the live sites, too. If you're interested, you can check out Mobin using the first link down below to get 20% off. Now, back to the video.

Colors are difficult and everyone has their own tastes, but I'm a big fan of starting with one primary color. Generally, this is your brand color. Then you can lighten it for a good background or darken it for text colors. Both good ways to incorporate subtle color and make an otherwise drab design look much more interesting. And with all of that, we're already halfway to a color ramp, which is what large companies use to build out chips, states, charts, and really anything else. But I also think it's important as a beginner to let the color find you. Like an announcement bar to grab attention or a focus state on an input or a green new chip on a link. These are all semantic colors, which are colors that have meaning and provide signifiers to the user. Blue for trust, red for danger or urgency, yellow for warning, and green for success. Make sure you use color for purpose, not just for decoration.

Now, designing in dark mode presents some pretty interesting challenges for us. First, this card is using a light border, which creates a bit too much contrast, so we'll lower that down. In dark mode, we don't have shadows like light mode. So, to create depth, we need to have a lighter card than the background. So, I'll make that adjustment. This chip is also far too bright, so we can dim down the saturation and brightness and flip that for the text to create some hierarchy. There's also a ton of flexibility for deep purples, reds, or greens, not just navy blue or gray.

But speaking of depth, shadows are a fantastic tool to use on light mode. This shadow, along with most, is too strong. So reducing the opacity and dialing up the blur helps a lot. The strength you'll need depends on the

foreground and background, but cards require less, while content that sits above other content, like popovers, will need stronger shadows. We can even use these techniques with inner and outer shadows to create effects like raised tactile buttons. Just remember, if the shadow is the first thing you notice on a design, you're not using it right now. To create strong designs, you'll need icons. Most icons are generally too large. So, the trick is to get the line height of your font, in this case 24 pixels, and make the icons the same size. And then tighten up the text. Sidebar links like this are actually just buttons without a background until you hover, which are often called ghost buttons. And if we isolate one and center it, we've got a perfect standalone button. These are super common when you have a primary and secondary CTA side by side. And a good guideline for padding on these is to double the height for the width. And these can be done with or without icons, too.

A good rule of design is when a user does anything, there should be a response. For example, every button needs at least four states: default, hovered, active, or pressed, and disabled. Sometimes you'll need a loading state, too, with a spinner. Inputs are even more critical. You'll need a focus state when the user clicks in, error states with red borders, and messages when something's wrong, and sometimes even warning states for optional issues. And this applies everywhere. loading spinners when data is fetching, success messages when an action completes, even micro animations on scroll or swipe. Every interaction needs a response.

And that brings us wonderfully into micro interactions. Micro interactions

are a form of feedback, but they set things up a notch. For example, this copy button has states and feedback when we hover and click, but we still don't know that we've copied anything. Instead, if we have this chip slide up, that's a micro interaction that confirms our action. And these can range from highly practical to much more fun and playful.
Finally, overlays are really important because if you screw them up, you're going to ruin the image and the text, too. In this case, we can't leave it as is. So, we could add in a full screen overlay, but it doesn't do the image justice. So instead add in a linear gradient that'll display the image then smoothly convert into a text readable background. Or if we're going for extra fancy we can add in a progressive blur on top of the gradient for an even more modern look. And that is more or less every UIUX concept all wrapped up in 10 minutes. If you want to check out Mobin, it will be the first link down below and you can get the link to all of the Figma assets used in this video down there too. Thank you so much for watching and I will see you in the next one.

in this video you will learn the key design principles and practical tips to build top tier websites consider this a guide to creativity because creativity is a process not a moment being creative isn't about being the first person to think of an idea it's all about connecting ideas you don't have to create new designs from a blank slate top designers take what is already present and combine those elements in a unique way but to be able to do that you need to know the rules of the game rule number one good design is as little design as possible it means focus on essential features and make them better and useful for the users it also means less colors words and clutter on the screen here's a common mistake when designing a website you start with the header and then go down from there or you are thinking about the overall structure how many sections do I need how wide they should be how should I design the buttons that that's a lot of hows each of these questions will slow you down and drain your creativity instead ask what's the key functionality or the main selling point of this website for a lot of websites it could be a heading input field and a button start from there at this point design as little as

possible chances are that's all you needed anyway don't complicate websites by adding too many elements that frustrate users and looks ugly as well our brain has evolved to simplify things and looks for key visual information only so why not choose the easy way and keep things simple it's a win-win situation rule number two use the law of similarity and proximity to simplify the design you can use shape size color and spacing to group elements gestal Theory emphasizes that the whole of something is greater than its parts focusing on how our minds perceive patterns and holes rather than just individual elements our brain first processes the information as a whole and as we spend more time looking at something we start to notice the small details as well so your first goal is to make the design simple enough to be understood as a whole in simple words the design should be scannable within seconds this ties nicely with the first rule as well the law of similarity not only makes the design better and consistent it's easier to implement as well the law of proximity on the other hand gives you a better understanding of layout and spacing rule number three elements need more spacing than you think when you are focused on designing a specific element the space might seem too much to you but the users scan the whole UI before focusing on individual elements so start with a lot of spacing and look at the design as a whole then start to remove it until you are happy with the results but doing this manually becomes boring and repetitive so you need a system in place rule number four use a design system especially if you are designing a big and complex website or app because it's made up of essential elements and components there are multiple ways to create a design system for a simple website you just need to Define key Design Elements and you are good to go for uis you need more complex and detailed design system that covers a lot of scenarios once you understand the basic design principles Behind These systems you don't really need a CSS framework to style your websites let's start with spacing you can use this list to get started or create your own system just have the values that are divisible by four now spacing totally depends on the context it's a very bad idea to design with lauram ipsum or vague data because a spacing that is perfect for this card can be a disaster for this one the system is is just there to help you pick a value quickly so you can play with different values instead of trying random values on the fly in the previous example we started with a lot of spacing like 40 pixels then bring elements closer that belong together to do that pick a value from this system let's try 20 it's still pretty big let's try 12 perfect but generally we use REM units for font size and margins so the design can adapt to the user system preference to assign REM values just divide the pixel value by 16 the new system will look something like this a better way is to set these values as variables so you can play with different values and see what works best same thing for your fonts and colors handpick few values and assign them as Global variables you can get started by picking any one font and type scale that fits your project there is no real science in choosing colors so don't fall for those tutorials or articles that teach you the psychology of colors just pick a dark and light color for your text and background and two more to add some personality just make sure the colors are legible and don't overwhelm the users for the same reason avoid text to line Center especially for paragraphs and smaller text size one more point line height is inversely proportional to the font size that means smaller text needs greater line height for better legibility greater line height also acts as margin top on text elements so you don't have to assign spacing between all text elements it's already done for you now that you have your fonts and colors in place design the key elements start with the links and buttons you generally

need two types of each one for primary actions and one for secondary actions once we have a design system in place we can start the actual design process web design is all about putting the right elements at the right place with the right sizing that brings us to rule number five hierarchy is everything we need to emphasize certain elements on the page to help users navigate and find important actions to emphasize important elements we can use size weight and color but it's very easy to overdo these things so start small you will be surprised to see how little changes can make a big impact on the overall design now to emphasize an element ask yourself what's the first thing the user will look for I guess it's the title so we need to emphasize it let's start with the color but white on black has a pretty good contrast ratio so let's reduce the contrast from the secondary information sometimes to emphasize something you need to deemphasize other competing elements in our case it's not enough so let's add more contrast by increasing the font weight it's almost there but you can go a step further further and increase the font size as well and when you are done with the design zoom out to see if the title stands out from the secondary information we do this because the users will scan and look for key information to focus on if the design isn't scannable you need to do some adjustments it could be choosing different font size a darker color or simply a bit more spacing do whatever you can to emphasize the elements you know the users will look for sometimes it could be labels and sometimes it could be values or maybe an icon it all depends on the context not all H1 tags will have the same size and margins same thing is true for other tags as well sometimes the H3 or paragraph tag could have a bigger font size than the h2 tag it all depends on the context just emphasize the most important elements and keep the rest of the design as it is good design is less design and More Design is almost always results in uglier design but like everything in life there are a few exceptions to this rule as well introduce depth to add some character use colors and shadows to elevate important elements Shadows can also be used to replace solid borders the closer something feels to the user the more it will attract their focus speaking of Focus use your accent colors to highlight important elements one easy trick to add a bit of excitement is by replacing a solid color with a subtle gradient you could also work on your lists and tables to make them more fun and engaging for the users and try using cards for Bland elements but the question is how do you get these ideas in the beginning I said creativity is a process not a moment now it's time to explain that process step one know the basics that we have covered already also read these books they have some really good practical tips to build top tier websites the second step is finding a source of inspiration you can look at the top tier websites and study their style or check out some amazing work on figma community I personally use mobin to take design Inspirations for my projects so I asked them to sponsor this video and thankfully they agreed say you are designing a testimonial section for a finance app go to filters and search for testimonial section then set the app category to finance now we have the testimonial section for some top tier apps in the world now look around and save the ones you like to your library whether you are designing for mobile or a full-blown web app mobin has a huge library of tried and tested designs so definitely include it in your design process once you have gathered enough Inspirations it's time to work over those designs in your mind trust is crucial for finance apps so the designers Must Have Spent A lot lot of time and research on the testimonial section let's try to look at these as users and make a note of key things you like about these designs for me they were simple and unique I really like the ones with a human face and simple language I

hate generic testimonial sections that have a bunch of reviews with no emotions so I have few ideas now we need two to three good reviews ideally with great images and we need big and bold text to emphasize them but don't go designing yet once you have some Initial Ideas try to step away from the problem and do something else this is a very important step in the creative process this is not just limited to design if you are stuck with a problem watch few tutorials or read some articles then think of these potential Solutions in your mind but don't act on it just take a break and do something else I promise when you revisit the problem new ideas will come naturally to you if this doesn't work it means you are under a lot of stress lately or not getting proper sleep so work on that first let's say you got some new ideas and finished your design step five is to not fall in love with it we all have personal biases and see things in a certain way so first test your design by showing it to your friends or colleagues if they like it test it with your users and always be open to adjust the design based on feedback sometimes you have to design several ter websites just to discover that you designed one good pricing section in the third design just finish something anything stop planning and thinking to design and just design it doesn't matter how good or how bad it is you just need to prove to yourself that you have what it takes to produce something creativity is not just a process it's also a state of mind

So, this is a pretty average nav design that we see everywhere, but some users may find it boring or too basic. To fix this, all we need is a few shades of the same color and then layer them like this. The idea is pretty simple. We are increasing the lightness value by 0.1 and then add the lighter color on top to create a sense of depth. I have covered these concepts in the colors video, so feel free to watch it before or after watching this video. But for now, let's take things to the next level. Level one would be a small shadow that is created by adding a light border or glow on top and then some dark shadow at the bottom. Combining soft and dark shadows gives a much more realistic feel than one basic shadow. Then we can just bump these values by a few pixels to add more depth. These two shadows are enough for most use cases, but you can always go one level higher by pushing these values by a few more pixels. Then it's up to you to decide which shadow works best for which element. For example, out of these three shadows, the small one feels much more natural than the other. So, to recap, it's a very simple two-step process. First, create three to four shades of the same color and then create some shadows. Now, start playing with depth. We have a pretty standard profile card here. Nothing wrong with it, but some may find it a little boring. So, let's follow our two steps. First, create layers by adding a lighter color on important elements. Then add the small shadow to add more depth. We can make it a bit more interesting by adding a bigger shadow on hover. Works best on light mode. The default theme for most people. So never ignore light mode just because you never use it. Now that we have the basics down, let's fix some boring UIs. We are going to start with this clean and simple design and increase the complexity as we move forward. As always, we start by adding a background color that's a bit lighter than the page itself. Then let's highlight the selected tab by adding a lighter shade, but that's made the text and icon color a bit muted. So, we got to increase the lightness on those two as well. Again, if this seems a bit confusing, I highly recommend watching the colors video. Now, let's highlight these drop downs as well as they are the main elements of this UI. This is already working, but we can add more depth by combining a gradient with a lighter inner

shadow on top. The shiny highlight up top complements these kinds of linear gradients really well. like as if the light coming from the top and that's why the top part is lighter than the bottom. But this was too easy to fix. Let's try a very common and boring UI element radio buttons. First of all, we are going to wrap everything inside a lighter card. Then highlight the options and add a bit of spacing. Also, we need to emphasize the selected option as well. Now, let's improve the typography and rearrange things to create hierarchy. The design can be further improved by adding a bit more depth to the selected card. This is the same small shadow we used in the beginning where we used a light inset shadow up top and a dark shadow at the bottom. Again, we are trying to sell the effect of light hitting this card because it's elevated and closer to the user making it more important. This is a pretty brilliant technique in UI design. You know who else is Brilliant? The sponsor of this video. Brilliant is a learning app designed to be uniquely effective. Each lesson is filled with hands-on problem solving that lets you play with concepts, a method proven to be six times more effective than watching lecture videos. Brilliant starts you with mastering the foundations, then helps you level up to increasingly challenging problems. It has a perfect mix of engaging problems, competitive features, and daily encouragement that keeps you motivated and on track. Plus, all content on Brilliant is crafted by an award-winning team of teachers and professionals from top tier institutions. Whether you're learning to code, build formulas, design electrical circuits, run simulations, or explore cuttingedge topics like AI, you can try it all for free. Just visit brilliant.org/sided or scan the QR code on screen or click on the link in the description. Brilliant's also given our viewers 20% off an annual premium subscription, which gives you unlimited daily access to everything on Brilliant. So, here is the before and after of last UI we did. Now let's do some in light theme as well. This is kind of overall big picture UI. Again, pretty familiar and basic style. A sidebar, two cards on top that contains big and bold text. Then some kind of graph and finally a table. Right now everything is kind of blending in together. There is no hierarchy. Let's choose a darker shade for the background and leave these four main elements as it is. And immediately these four elements start popping off the page like they want your attention. But that's also the problem. So the next step is to deemphasize few of them. Let's start with this table at the bottom. Then a bit darker shade for the graph as well. But notice it's lighter than the table. And because we are using color to create different layers, we can remove borders on the lighter elements. We can create even more depth by adding a small shadow on the smaller card and a big shadow on the bigger one. Of course, they could use the same shadow or the smaller one have the big shadow depending on the context. The main idea is to raise or lower certain elements. On that note, we can add a dark inset shadow on top and a light inset shadow at the bottom of the table, like if it's deeper than everything else. We can also add a slightly darker background color to really sell this effect. And the design is changed so much by just using four shades of gray and some shadow. To take it to the next level, try adding some color. Of course, the color will depend on the context, but most colors will work if done correctly. Now let's use whatever we have done so far and try to fix this UI. Again, nothing wrong with it. It's clean and simple, but just too basic and maybe boring for some users. We have a light background color. Let's use it to create a darker and lighter shade to create three shades in total. As we have seen so far, we do this to create layering of top, middle, and bottom elements. Step one would be to change the page color to bg dark as it's the base for everything that comes on top of it. Then we can separate these three sections

by applying the BG color. Let's start with section one. Nice round curves can make anything beautiful and using BG light for the interactive elements makes sense as they are the elements that actually make this interface. Finally, some shadow and we can move on to section two. Round corners, padding, and a shadow to start things off. Now that we have a card, we can rearrange some stuff to improve the design. And if you notice, we have also removed the border from the pro tag as we can just use a lighter shade to highlight it. So let's do the similar thing with this progress bar to match our overall design. If you notice, we are using dark and light inset shadow to push it into the card. So the actual progress bar appears slightly elevated. And while we are here, this text seems important, but the typography is lacking. So let's fix that as well. Perfect. Let's move to the final section. You might think there is little to no room for improvement as they are just two radio buttons. And why even bother wasting time on this when you can be designing or building much important things. And I agree. Don't waste time perfecting every little detail when the outcome doesn't worth the effort. But adding depth is so satisfying and literally takes a few lines of code that makes it worth it. Let's start by highlighting both options. And as we did earlier, we can do better than this basic version. Why not add some icon to complement the option? You can find these anywhere online. All it takes is one click to copy the SVG. Now, this button feels out of place, so let's send it to the right and use the same lighter background to make it part of the section. Also, this heading is not necessary as this section is self-explanatory. Now, let's bring everything together to see how they look as a whole UI. This is nice, but let's expand the billing section to match the model section. I hope you can see the night and day difference between before and after. Speaking of night and day, this works on dark theme as well. And all the dark theme examples we've seen earlier will work on light theme as well. You just need to use color and shadow variables to assign background and box shadows. Again, watch the colors video if you haven't already. The idea is very simple. You can turn an average design to good design just by using depth. Of course, we could have done tons of other things to further improve the design, but let me tell you a design secret. It takes a lot less effort to take an average design to good tier than it is to take a good design to S tier. It's kind of like how in video games there is big graphics change when you go from normal to high settings. But when you go from high to ultra, there is a huge loss in FPS, but you don't really see it in graphics quality. The high setting is the sweet spot for good graphics and playable FPS. And as I shown in this video, depth is that easy way to fix boring UIs.